

PHIL 340 Examination

Comparative Philosophy: East and West

Instructions:

- Answer all questions.
- For Questions 1–4, choose the best option.
- For Questions 5–8, write brief but precise answers.

1. In Kantian ethics, what principle determines whether an action is morally permissible?

- (A) The action maximizes overall happiness
- (B) The action can be willed as a universal law without contradiction
- (C) The action aligns with natural law
- (D) The action is commanded by divine authority

2. Which concept is central to Daoist philosophy as articulated in the *Daodejing*?

- (A) *Ren* (benevolence or humaneness)
- (B) *Wu wei* (effortless action or non-interference)
- (C) *Dharma* (duty or righteousness)
- (D) *Logos* (rational principle)

3. In Aristotelian virtue ethics, what is the definition of virtue?

- (A) Adherence to moral rules regardless of consequences
- (B) A disposition to act according to the mean between extremes
- (C) The pursuit of pleasure and avoidance of pain
- (D) Obedience to the will of the gods

4. Which Buddhist concept refers to the idea that all phenomena are without permanent, independent existence?

- (A) *Dukkha* (suffering)
- (B) *Anatta* (non-self)
- (C) *Karma* (action and consequence)
- (D) *Nirvana* (liberation)

5. Compare and contrast Confucian ethics with Kantian deontology. How do both approaches emphasize duty and moral obligation, and where do they diverge in their foundations and practical applications?
6. Explain the concept of the *Atman* in Hindu philosophy and how it relates to *Brahman*. How does this contrast with the Buddhist doctrine of *Anatta* (no-self)?
7. Discuss Plato's Theory of Forms and its implications for epistemology and metaphysics. How does this theory address the problem of universals and the nature of reality?
8. Explain the existentialist notion of radical freedom as discussed by Jean-Paul Sartre. How does this concept relate to authenticity and bad faith, and what are its implications for moral responsibility?